

INNOVATIONS IN FINANCE

LECTURE 4 : DATA IN FINANCE

Make an impact



INTRODUCTION

FIVE MINUTES WITH A STRANGER'S BANK ACCOUNT



Make an impact



WHO IS THIS PERSON?

One month of a real-looking current account. Five minutes, in pairs, on paper.

DATE	LIBELLÉ	MONTANT
02/03	VIR SALAIRE DECATHLON CAMPUS SA	+2 480,00
03/03	PRLV LOYER SCI DES LILAS	-1 150,00
03/03	PRLV ORANGE MOBILE	-24,99
05/03	CB PHARMACIE DU CENTRE LILLE	-34,20
07/03	CB SELARL AVOCATS DELAUNAY	-1 200,00
08/03	ANNULATION PRLV NETFLIX	0,00
09/03	CB SNCF CONNECT	-89,00
12/03	CB CABINET MEDICAL LILLE	-60,00
14/03	VIR EMIS GARANTIE LOCATION	-900,00
15/03	CB IKEA LOMME	-342,80
16/03	CB SNCF CONNECT	-89,00
18/03	CB LA POSTE REEXPEDITION	-12,50
20/03	PRLV BASIC FIT	-29,99
22/03	CB PHARMACIE DU CENTRE LILLE	-34,20
24/03	PRLV LOYER M. BERTRAND	-780,00
28/03	CB SNCF CONNECT	-89,00

YOUR TASK

- Who is this person?
- What happened to them this month?
- What are they going to do next month?

5 minutes. Pairs. Paper.

RULES

No internet. Everything you need is on the left.

Write your conclusions as sentences, not as guesses. You will be asked to justify each one from a specific line.





WHAT YOU HAD, AND WHAT YOU MADE

The gap between those two things is where all the value and all the danger sit

WHAT WAS IN THE FILE

Sixteen rows. A date, a label, an amount. That is all.

Nothing else. In particular, not:

- her name
- her age
- her marital status
- her health
- her address
- the word "separation"

This is DATA.

WHAT YOU PRODUCED IN FIVE MINUTES

- A separation, and a move to a smaller flat
- An ongoing health issue
- A weekly journey to another city
- An employer, and a salary band
- A likely drop in disposable income next month
- A person who will need credit within six months

This is INFERENCE. It is worth far more.

You did that in five minutes, on one person, with sixteen rows and no tools.

A bank does it every night, on twenty million customers, with five years of history. That is what this session is about — and it is why the second half is about the law.





"DATA IS THE NEW OIL" IS WRONG

And the four ways it is wrong tell you how the industry actually works

Oil is scarce.

Data is abundant and growing.

Scarcity is not where the value is. Almost nobody's problem is having too little data.

Oil is rival.

Data is non-rival.

If I burn a barrel, you cannot. If I use your data, you still have it — and so does everyone you sold it to.

Oil is worth something on its own.

Data is worth nothing on its own.

A transaction line has no value. The same line joined to five years of history has a lot.

Oil has an owner.

Data has a subject.

The barrel has no opinion about being refined. The person in that bank statement has rights, and they are enforceable.

The last line is the one that costs companies money. Oil does not have a lawyer.





THE ONLY THING DATA IS FOR

Keep this in your pocket for the whole session

Data is worth exactly what the decision it enables is worth. Nothing more.

1

Collect

Get it in.

APIs, files, an ERP export, a scraper, a satellite. Unglamorous, and where most of the work actually is.

2

Store

Keep it usable.

A place where it can be found again, joined to other things, and trusted six months from now.

3

Process

Make it comparable.

Clean it, join it, resolve who is who. This is 80% of the effort and it is never in the pitch deck.

4

Decide

Act on it.

Grant the loan. Refuse the payment. Place the trade. Call the client. This is the only step that creates value.

THE UNCOMFORTABLE CONSEQUENCE

Steps 1 to 3 cost money and produce nothing. A company that collects, stores and processes beautifully but never changes a decision has built an expensive museum. Most corporate data projects die between step 3 and step 4 — and they die quietly, because nobody wants to say so.



WHERE WE ARE GOING

Four blocks, and the second half is the one that will surprise you

1

What data is

You have just done it. Raw data, inference, and why the oil metaphor misleads.

2

Where to get it

Five families of financial data — including three nobody teaches, and one satellite company.

3

How it becomes useful

Collect, store, process, decide — on a real pipeline, with real dirty data.

4

What stops you

GDPR, re-identification, sovereignty and bias. This block is not a compliance lecture.

Next week: AI in finance. Everything in that session eats what we build today.





WHERE THE DATA COMES FROM

FIVE FAMILIES, THREE OF WHICH NOBODY TEACHES



Make an impact



FIVE PLACES FINANCIAL DATA COMES FROM

Ranked, roughly, by how much competitive advantage they give you

1

Transactional

What you see because you are in the flow.

Bank movements, card payments, terminal data. The most valuable, and the hardest to get if you are not already there.

2

Accounting

The legally mandated record of everything.

FEC, general ledger, trial balance. Standardised by law in France, machine-readable, and almost nobody outside accounting knows it exists.

3

Management / ERP

How the company actually runs.

Orders, inventory, purchasing, payroll and headcount. The operational truth, usually months ahead of the accounts.

4

Market & reference

The prices, and who is who.

Quotes, curves, ratings, identifiers, company registries and KYB. Mostly bought — and it is a very large industry.

5

Alternative

Everything else that correlates.

Satellite imagery, shipping movements, web scraping, card panels, job postings. Expensive, noisy, occasionally decisive.

Families 2 and 3 are where a corporate finance job actually lives. They get roughly zero minutes in most fintech courses.





THE POSITIONAL ADVANTAGE

You cannot buy this one. You have to be standing in the right place.

Whoever sees the transaction can lend against it. Everyone else is guessing.

Shopify

sees every sale a merchant makes, in real time

So it lends to that merchant, and repays itself out of future sales. Better underwriting AND better collection than the merchant's own bank.

A payment processor

sees revenue before the accountant does

Card receipts today are a better signal of solvency than a balance sheet from eighteen months ago.

The bank

used to see everything

Then the customer started paying with Apple Pay, buying with Klarna and banking with Revolut. The flow left, and the visibility went with it.

Session 2 called this embedded finance. It is the same phenomenon, seen from the data side.





THE DATASET NOBODY TOLD YOU ABOUT: THE FEC

Every French company is legally required to be able to produce it. It is machine-readable.

FICHIER DES ÉCRITURES COMPTABLES

Compulsory since 2014 for any company keeping computerised accounts. It must be produced on demand during a tax audit.

It is a flat file containing every single accounting entry of the financial year, in a format fixed by the tax authority — same columns, same order, for every company in France.

A regulator standardised the accounting data of an entire country. Almost nobody outside the profession has noticed.

WHAT ONE LINE CONTAINS

Journal	which book — sales, purchases, bank
Date	when it was posted
Account	the chart-of-accounts code, and its label
Third party	the customer or supplier account
Reference	the invoice or document number
Label	the free-text description
Debit / Credit	the amounts
Lettering	which payment cleared which invoice

WHY A FINANCE PERSON SHOULD CARE

It is exhaustive

Not a summary. Every entry, with its counterpart.

It is standardised

The same parser works on any French company. That is rare and enormously valuable.

It reveals behaviour

The lettering column tells you which invoices were paid late, by whom, and by how many days.

The balance sheet is the summary. The general ledger is the story. The FEC is the raw material — and it is the only one you can actually compute on.





THE ERP: WHAT THE COMPANY KNOWS BEFORE THE ACCOUNTANT DOES

Operational data runs weeks or months ahead of the financial statements

Sales & orders

Order book, delivery status, backlog, cancellations, discounts granted.

An order today is revenue in three months. The accounts will not show it until then.

Purchasing & stock

Supplier orders, inventory levels, lead times, stock ageing.

Inventory building up is a demand problem that appears in cash long before it appears in profit.

Customers & receivables

Who owes what, since when, and the whole dispute history.

This is the poste client from session 2 — and it is where DSO actually lives.

Payroll & headcount

Headcount, contract types, payroll cost, social charges, turnover, the DSN filing.

The largest fixed cost in most service companies, and the earliest indicator that something is changing.

Accounting tells you what happened. The ERP tells you what is happening. Only one of those is useful for a forecast.





KYB: PROVING A COMPANY IS WHAT IT SAYS IT IS

A regulatory obligation that turned into a data industry

Any regulated firm must know who its business clients really are — and who ultimately owns them.

Company registry

RNE / INPI, INSEE

Legal existence, SIREN, address, directors, filed accounts, articles.

Legal announcements

BODACC

Insolvency proceedings, disposals, changes of control. The early warning layer.

Beneficial ownership

Registre des bénéficiaires effectifs

Who actually owns the company behind the holding structure. The whole point of the exercise.

Sanctions & PEP

EU and national lists

Sanctioned entities, politically exposed persons. Non-negotiable, and checked continuously.

Adverse media

Press and court records

The judgement layer — and the one that cannot be fully automated.

Almost all of it is public and free. The business is not owning it — it is joining it, keeping it fresh, and being accountable for the answer.





SOMEBODY SELLS THE NUMBERS

Market data is not a public good. It is one of the most profitable businesses in finance.

WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY BUYING

Prices	quotes, trades, order books, in real time
Curves	rates, credit spreads, volatility surfaces
Reference data	identifiers, corporate actions, who owns whom
Fundamentals	filings, estimates, ratings

THE ECONOMICS THAT SURPRISE PEOPLE

A Bloomberg terminal costs roughly \$30,000 a year, per user, and there are several hundred thousand of them.

Do the multiplication. Selling numbers — not advice, not execution, just the numbers — is a multi-billion-dollar industry with famously high margins.

WHY ANYONE PAYS, WHEN PRICES ARE 'PUBLIC'

Latency

Free data is delayed. Delay is worthless to anyone trading.

Cleanliness

Someone has already fixed the splits, the currencies and the identifiers.

Coverage & liability

One contract, everything, and somebody to blame if it is wrong.

Nobody is paying \$30,000 for numbers they could find. They are paying for cleaned, instant, complete, and someone else's responsibility.

Remember that sentence. It is the business model of almost every data company in this session.





WHAT FRANCE GIVES YOU FOR FREE

A serious amount of financial data is public, official, and two clicks away

data.gouv.fr

The national open data portal — thousands of datasets, all public administrations.

INSEE

The company directory (SIRENE), demographics, price indices, sector statistics.

INPI / RNE

The national company register: legal identity, directors, filed accounts, beneficial owners.

BODACC

Official legal announcements: incorporations, disposals, insolvency proceedings.

Banque de France

Payment statistics, credit data, business surveys, company failure rates.

ECB Data Portal

Rates, monetary aggregates, balance of payments, banking statistics for the euro area.

Open banking APIs

Under PSD2 — a customer's own bank data, with their consent. Session 2.

You can build a genuinely useful financial analysis of any French company, tonight, for zero euros. Most people never try because nobody told them the door was open.





PAPPERS: FREE DATA, MADE USABLE

A regulation opened a door in 2020. Two people walked through it.

2015

The law changes

The loi Macron requires company registry data to be freely accessible to everyone.

June 2020

The data actually opens

The INPI finishes publishing the register as open data. Free, complete, and effectively unusable in that state.

July 2020

Somebody builds the interface

Pierre Fruchard — a former business lawyer who had been paying hundreds of euros a year for the same information — launches Pappers with Romain Banchetti.

Today

The incumbents have a problem

Around 70 million documents on more than 3.6 million French companies, free. The paid incumbents did not enjoy it.

THE BUSINESS MODEL

Roughly 1% of users pay — mostly for API access — and that funds free access for the other 99%.

THE LESSON

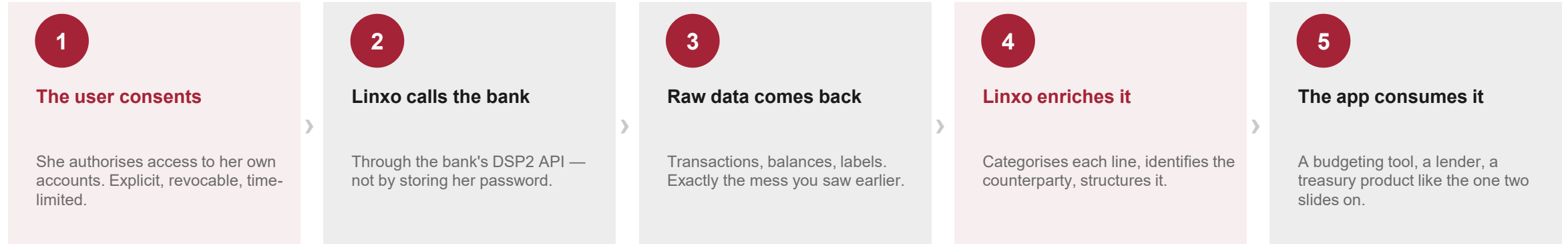
The data was free for everyone, for years. The value was in making it usable. That is a product decision, not a data one.





LINXO: THE PIPE BETWEEN A BANK AND EVERYTHING ELSE

A French company whose entire existence was created by a directive



THE REGULATORY IDENTITY CARD

Founded	2010, in France — before PSD2 existed
Licence	Payment institution, authorised by the ACPR
Services	DSP2 services 7 and 8 — payment initiation and account information
Owner	Crédit Agricole took a majority stake in 2020



Then ask the interesting question: why did a bank buy the company that gives everyone else access to bank data?

Session 2 gave you the answer. Buy, partner, or build — and this was a bank buying its way back into a flow it was losing.





ALTERNATIVE DATA: MEASURING THE WORLD DIRECTLY

Do not ask the company how it is doing. Go and look.

Satellite imagery	Cars in a retailer's car parks. Oil in floating-roof tanks, measured by the shadow the roof casts.
Ship movements	AIS transponders — and the vessels that switch them off, which is itself a signal.
Card panels	Anonymised, aggregated spending from millions of cards. Revenue estimates before the earnings release.
Web scraping	Prices, stock availability, review counts, job postings. Hiring is a strategy leak.
App and web traffic	Downloads, active users, search volume — for companies whose product is an app.

AND THE HONEST PROBLEMS, BEFORE YOU GET EXCITED

Sample bias

A card panel is not the population. If your panel skews young and urban, so does your conclusion.

Alpha decays

The moment the provider sells the same feed to a hundred funds, the edge is priced in. You are buying a diminishing asset.

Legal exposure

Scraping, personal data, and material non-public information are three different ways to end up in front of a regulator.





HORMUZ, 2026: WHEN SATELLITES BECAME THE MARKET

Twenty percent of the world's oil trade passes through a strait 39 km wide

WHAT TRADERS NEEDED TO SEE

- Which tankers are actually transiting, and how many
- Which terminals and refineries have been hit
- How much oil is sitting in floating storage
- Where the mines and the naval assets are
- Whether a declared disruption is real or rhetoric

WHY IT MOVED MONEY

Every escalation moved Brent, marine insurance premiums and shipping rates within hours.

At one point in 2026, weekly transits through the strait reportedly fell to around 35 vessels — less than half the previous week.

An image was not journalism. It was a position.

THE VALUE CHAIN, IN ONE REAL EXAMPLE

Collect

A satellite passes over the strait.

Process

Count the hulls. Measure the tank shadows. Detect the fires.

Decide

Adjust the position. Reprice the insurance. Reroute the fleet.

This is the clearest example in the course of raw data becoming a decision — and of how much that decision is worth.



KAYRROS: TURNING PIXELS INTO A POSITION

A French company that measures the physical economy from orbit



HOW YOU MEASURE OIL FROM SPACE

Large storage tanks have a floating lid that rests on the oil and sinks as the tank empties. From above, the shadow cast inside the tank tells you how full it is. Do that for every tank on earth, every few days, and you have the world's oil inventory — without asking anyone.

WHO BUYS IT, AND WHY

Traders	a view on supply before the official statistics
Insurers	physical risk on assets they cover
Shipowners	routing and exposure decisions
Regulators	methane emissions, compliance, verification

READ IT AGAINST THE VALUE CHAIN

Collect

Satellite passes. Copernicus is free and open — that mattered enormously.

Process

Detect the tanks, measure the shadows, correct for cloud and angle. This is the product.

Decide

A trading position, an insurance premium, a rerouted vessel.



AND THEN SOMEBODY SWITCHED IT OFF

The sovereignty lesson, delivered live, three months ago

2026

The American operators restrict access

Planet Labs imposes a delay on Gulf of Oman imagery, then withholds it indefinitely. Vantor, formerly Maxar, follows. US imagery firms operate under federal licence — in wartime, Washington can restrict what they publish.

Meanwhile

Copernicus keeps working

The EU's earth observation programme is free, open and near-real-time. It becomes the last independent source. French firms built on it — Kayrros among them — take orders from energy traders, insurers, shipowners and media working around the US restrictions.

13 July 2026

Brussels agrees to a 24-hour delay

Following a US request, the Council adopts a 24-hour delay on Copernicus imagery of the strait, with five sets of coordinates defining the zone. Less restrictive than the American blackout — but the principle of open access has moved.

A European company lost its competitive advantage because of a decision taken in Washington and ratified in Brussels.

Your data supply is only as sovereign as the entity that controls the sensor. Remember that in twenty minutes.





FROM RAW DATA TO A DECISION

WHERE THE WORK ACTUALLY IS

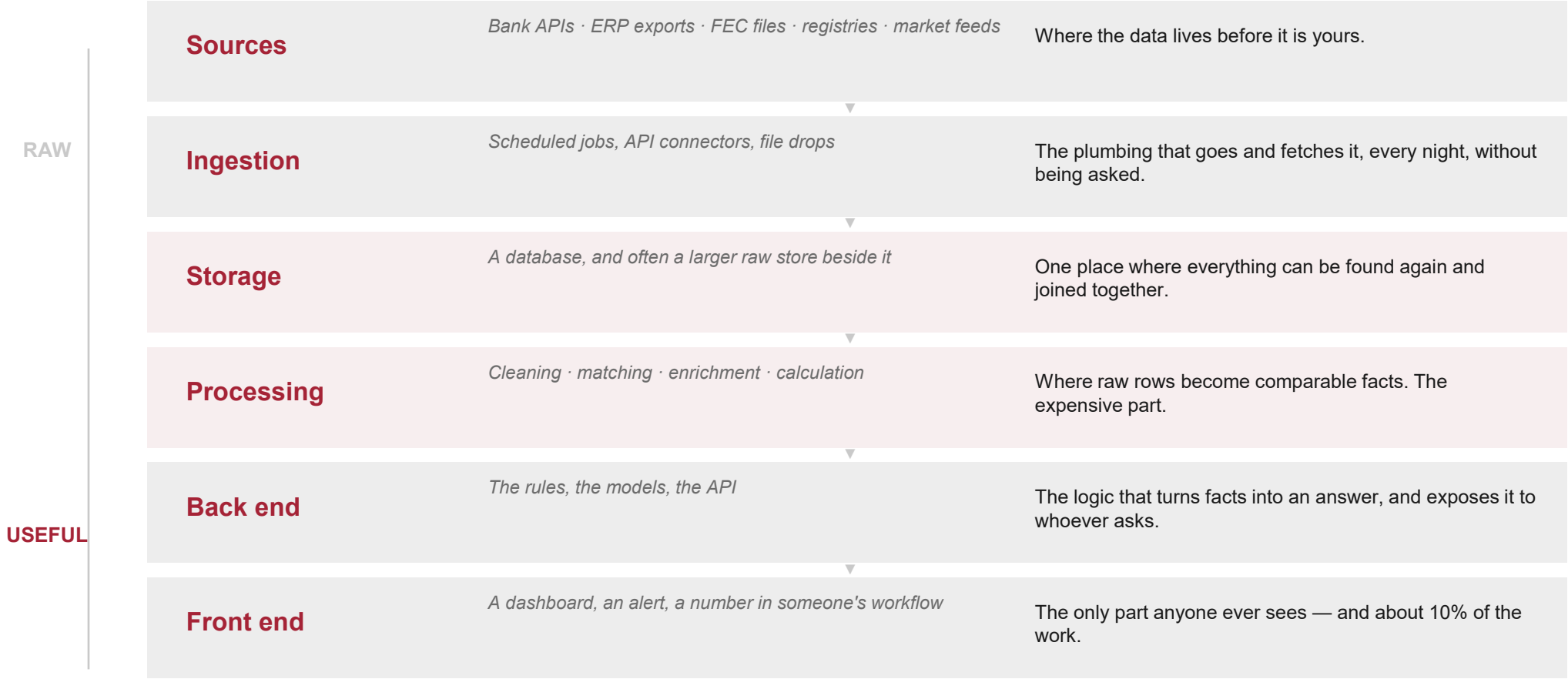


Make an impact



WHAT THE MACHINE LOOKS LIKE

You will never build this. You will absolutely have to talk to people who do.



Every layer can be bought. What cannot be bought is knowing which decision it all has to serve.





THE 80% NOBODY PHOTOGRAPHS

Ask anyone who does this for a living what they actually spend their time on

Are these the same company? Your entire analysis depends on the answer.

SOC GENERALE

Société Générale S.A.

SG PARIS

SOCIETE GENERALE SA

Ste Generale

SOCGEN

SG CIB

societe-generale

WHY IT IS GENUINELY HARD

- Typos, abbreviations, accents, legal forms
- The same name for different legal entities
- Companies that merge, split or rename
- No shared identifier across the sources

WHAT BREAKS IF YOU GET IT WRONG

- Your exposure to a counterparty is understated
- The same client is scored twice, differently
- A sanctions check silently misses
- Your DSO by customer is meaningless

THE FIX, AND WHY IDENTIFIERS MATTER

Stop matching on names. Match on identifiers — SIREN in France, LEI for financial counterparties. This is why registries and reference data are a business, and why "boring" standardisation work quietly decides whether anything downstream works.





A REAL PIPELINE: FORECASTING A COMPANY'S CASH

Disclosure — this is Kowikan, my company. Same rules as the last two sessions.

The question: how much cash will this company have in 90 days, and on which day does it get tight?

Bank movements	Aggregation APIs, under PSD2	What actually moved. The ground truth — but the labels are a mess.
Customer invoices	Invoicing tool or ERP	What is owed, and when it was promised. Expected in, not yet arrived.
Supplier invoices	ERP, purchasing	What is owed out, and when it will actually be paid.
Payment behaviour	History, and the FEC lettering column	This client says 30 days and pays in 52. That is the number that matters.
Payroll	Payroll system, DSN	The largest and most predictable outflow. Also personal data.
Tax and social deadlines	Public calendars	VAT, corporate tax, social contributions. Known dates, large amounts.

Six sources. Five of the five families from the first block. Not one of them arrives clean.





AND NOW THE PART THAT TAKES THE TIME

What the data actually looks like when it arrives

REAL BANK LABELS

CB SARL DUP*** 06/03

Which supplier is that?

VIR RECU 0034221

From which client, for which invoice?

PRLV ORG SOC 3B12

Which social contribution?

CB AMZN MKTP FR*2K9

Office supplies, or hardware?

VIR M DUPONT

The director, or a customer?

SO THE WORK IS

- Categorise every label
- Match payments to invoices
- Resolve who is who
- Flag what cannot be resolved — and say so

THE HONEST BIT

[TO COMPLETE — the hardest data problem you have actually hit, what percentage of labels resolve automatically, and what you still do by hand. Do not delete this box.]

AND THE DECISION IT FEEDS

Which invoices to chase first, how much cash can be placed until when — session 3 — and which week to warn the director about. Nothing else in this pipeline matters if that last part does not happen.

Nobody will ever demo this slide. It is where the product is actually built, and it is most of the cost.





YOUR TURN: DESIGN THE DATA

Ten minutes in groups of four. Design the inputs, not the algorithm.

THE BRIEF

You work for a company with 400 SME customers. You want to know, each Monday, which of them is likely to pay late this month.

1

What data do you need?

Be specific. "Financial data" is not an answer. Name the fields.

2

Where does each piece come from?

Internal, bought, or public? Use the five families.

3

What will be dirty or missing?

Name at least two things that will break, and say what you do about them.

4

What decision changes?

If you cannot answer this one, you have built a museum.

YOU WILL BE CHALLENGED ON

- Did you use anything other than the accounts?
- Does your data exist before the late payment, or only after it?
- Would you be comfortable if the client saw your inputs?
- What happens the first week the model is wrong?

HOW IT RUNS

7 min design, in groups

3 min two groups present





WHAT STOPS YOU

AND WHY THE CONSTRAINT IS ALSO THE STRATEGY



Make an impact



GDPR, AS A WAY OF THINKING

Four questions to ask at the start of a project, not at the end of it

On what basis?

LAWFUL BASIS

Consent, contract, legal obligation, legitimate interest. You must pick one before you collect, and be able to name it.

What for, exactly?

PURPOSE LIMITATION

Data collected to run a payment cannot be quietly reused to score credit. "We might need it later" is not a purpose.

Do you need all of it?

MINIMISATION

Collect what the purpose requires and nothing more. The instinct to keep everything is now a liability, not an asset.

Can you undo it?

ERASURE AND RECTIFICATION

The person can require correction or deletion. Which — as session 3 showed — is a genuine problem if you put it on a blockchain.

Asked at the start, these are design constraints. Asked at the end, they are a reason to throw the project away.





THE ARTICLE THAT WILL SHAPE NEXT WEEK'S SESSION

GDPR Article 22 — the right not to be judged entirely by a machine

IN SUBSTANCE

A person has the right not to be subject to a decision based solely on automated processing that produces legal effects or similarly significantly affects them.

WHAT THAT MEANS IN PRACTICE

- A refused loan cannot be a pure machine output
- There must be meaningful human involvement
- The person can contest the decision
- And can obtain an explanation of the logic

WHY THAT IS GENUINELY HARD

The most accurate models are the least explainable. So there is a direct trade-off between how well a credit model performs and how well you can justify it to the person it just refused.

That is not a technical problem waiting to be solved. It is a choice.

THE QUESTION TO HOLD UNTIL NEXT WEEK

"Your application was refused" is not an explanation. Neither is "the model scored you at 412". So what is? Next week we look at credit scoring, and this article is the reason that session is not simply about accuracy. A model you cannot explain is a model you may not be allowed to use.





"ANONYMISED" DOES NOT MEAN ANONYMOUS

The most consequential misunderstanding in the whole field

WHAT PEOPLE THINK IT MEANS

"We removed the names and the account numbers, so the dataset is anonymous and we can use it freely."

This is said in good faith, constantly, in companies that are otherwise extremely careful.

WHY IT IS WRONG

Identity does not live in the name. It lives in the pattern.

Where you were, when, and how often is close to unique to you. Published research on credit card metadata has shown that a very small number of date-and-place points is enough to single out the great majority of individuals in a large dataset.

TEST IT ON THE OPENING EXERCISE

There was no name on that statement. But there is an employer, a city, a rent, a gym, a pharmacy and three identical train journeys. How many people in France match all of those at once? You did not need the name — and neither would anybody else.

If a dataset can be re-identified, it is still personal data, and the whole of GDPR still applies to it. "We anonymised it" is a claim you have to be able to defend.





WHERE DOES YOUR DATA PHYSICALLY LIVE?

And whose law does the company holding it answer to?

THE COLLISION

European law says personal data of Europeans is protected wherever it goes.

US law can compel an American company to hand over data it controls, including data stored on servers outside the United States.

Both apply at once to the same file.

WHY IT IS NOT THEORETICAL

European courts have twice struck down the arrangements permitting transfers of personal data to the United States, on the grounds that surveillance law there was incompatible with European rights.

Every transfer framework since has been built in the shadow of those rulings.

THE EUROPEAN RESPONSE, AND WHAT IT COSTS

Certified cloud

State-backed security qualification, and joint ventures built to run US software under French control.

The Data Act

Rules on access, portability and switching provider — aimed squarely at lock-in.

The trade-off

Sovereign options are usually more expensive and less featured. That is the actual decision.

Twenty minutes ago a French company lost its edge because Washington restricted a satellite feed. This is the same question, applied to your customer database.





YOU CANNOT REMOVE A VARIABLE BY DELETING IT

Proxy discrimination — the reason 'we don't use gender' proves nothing

Remove the protected variable, and the model will rebuild it from everything else you left in.

Gender	Purchase categories, retailer names, part-time work patterns, career gaps
Age	Device type, subscription mix, transaction channel, how you contact the bank
Origin or ethnicity	Postcode, first name, money transfers to specific countries
Health	Pharmacy frequency, specialist consultations, insurance changes
Income and class	Postcode, the supermarket you use, the make of your car, holiday timing

The only honest test is on the output, not the input: does the model produce systematically different outcomes for groups it is not allowed to consider?





WRAP-UP

BACK TO THE BANK STATEMENT



Make an impact



SO WHO ACTUALLY WINS?

Not the ones with the most data. The ones standing in the right place.

Standing in the flow

Platforms, payment processors, ERPs

They see the transaction as it happens. Nobody can buy that position — you have to occupy it.

Owning the standard

Registries, identifiers, the FEC format

When everyone must speak your format, you decide what is comparable.

Making it usable

Pappers, market data vendors, analytics firms

The data was free or available. The product is cleaned, instant, complete and accountable.

Losing quietly

Whoever left the flow

The bank that became a back end to a wallet still holds the account. It no longer sees the behaviour.

The strategic question is never "how much data do we have?" It is "what do we see that nobody else does?"





BACK TO HER BANK STATEMENT

Same sixteen rows. You now know considerably more than you did at 9am.

You reconstructed a separation, a health issue
and a weekly journey — from sixteen rows,
in five minutes, with no tools.

Now answer three questions.

Who should be allowed to read that file?

For what purpose — and who decides when the purpose changes?

HOW IT RUNS

3 min in pairs

3 min three pairs answer

Rule you must name a lawful basis for every use
you allow

Her bank? Her insurer? A lender? Her employer?

THE POINT OF THE EXERCISE

This morning that file was a technical object. You now know it contains a person who never told anyone any of it. Every rule in the fourth block exists because somebody, somewhere, did exactly what you did — and then acted on it.

That is the whole session: data is not neutral, because inference is not neutral.





WHAT TO TAKE OUT OF TODAY

Five things — and the first one is the one to keep

1

Data is worth what the decision it enables is worth.

Collect, store and process are pure cost. Only "decide" creates value. Ask any data project which decision changed, and watch what happens.

2

The value is in the inference, not the record.

Nothing in that bank statement said "separation". You built it. That gap is where both the money and the law live.

3

The advantage is positional.

Whoever stands in the flow sees what others must guess. You cannot buy that position, and you can lose it without anyone leaving.

4

The unglamorous families are the useful ones.

FEC, general ledger, ERP, registries. Standardised, exhaustive, free or cheap — and taught nowhere.

5

Ask who can switch your data off.

A satellite feed, a cloud provider, a regulator, a partner. Kayrros did nothing wrong and lost its edge anyway.

Before next week: find one open data source that answers a real financial question — and say in one line what it cannot tell you.





DATA IN FINANCE

A company has built a data platform that ingests, cleans and stores everything perfectly. Nobody's behaviour has changed. What has it built?

- A.** A competitive advantage that will pay off later.
- B.** An expensive museum — value is created only at the decision step.
- C.** A GDPR breach.
- D.** A data lake, which is the correct first step.





DATA IN FINANCE

Why is the FEC unusually valuable as a data source?

- A.** Because it is confidential, so few people have it.
- B.** Because it is standardised by law, so one parser works on any French company.
- C.** Because it contains the company's strategic plan.
- D.** Because it is published publicly by the tax authority.





DATA IN FINANCE

A bank removes gender from its credit model. What has it achieved?

- A.** The model can no longer discriminate on gender.
- B.** Very little — correlated variables will reconstruct it. Only testing the outputs tells you anything.
- C.** Compliance with Article 22 of the GDPR.
- D.** A more accurate model.



DATA IN FINANCE

A European fintech's core data comes from a US satellite provider. Washington restricts publication. What was the mistake?

- A.** Choosing a foreign supplier — always buy European.
- B.** Not asking, on day one, who controls the sensor and under whose law they operate.
- C.** Nothing — this was unforeseeable.
- D.** Failing to sign a longer contract.



Make an impact

